

Project Documentation Phase

Documentation Plan

Field	Details
Project Name	[Your project name]
Documentation Lead	[Name]
Version	1.0
Date	30 September 2026
Status	Draft

1. Introduction

The Documentation Phase records everything about the project in a clear and organised way. Good documentation helps new team members understand the system, helps users operate it, and makes future maintenance much easier.

2. Objectives

- Capture the complete technical and functional details of the project.
- Give users clear guides so they can use the product easily.
- Make future updates and bug fixes faster.
- Keep a proper record for audit, handover and reference.

3. Types of Documentation

Document	Audience	Content
Requirements Document	Team, client	Business needs, features, user stories
Design Document	Developers	Architecture, database, UI design
Technical Documentation	Developers	Code structure, APIs, setup steps
Test Documentation	QA, developers	Test plan, test cases, results
User Manual	End users	Step-by-step guide to use the product
Admin Guide	Administrators	Configuration, backup, user management
Maintenance Guide	Support team	Troubleshooting, updates, known issues

4. Technical Documentation Contents

- System architecture and component overview.
- Database schema and ER diagram.
- API documentation (endpoints, inputs, outputs, error codes).
- Installation and environment setup steps.
- Code structure and important modules explained.
- Deployment and configuration details.

5. User Manual Contents

- Introduction and purpose of the product.
- How to sign up, log in and reset a password.
- Step-by-step instructions with screenshots for each feature.
- Frequently asked questions (FAQ).
- Troubleshooting common problems and contact details for support.

6. Documentation Standards

- Use simple, clear language and short sentences.
- Follow a common template, fonts and headings for all documents.

- Include version number, date and author on every document.
- Use diagrams and screenshots wherever they explain better than text.
- Store all documents in one shared, organised location.

7. Documentation Plan

Document	Owner	Deadline	Status
Technical Documentation	[Name]	[Date]	Not started
API Documentation	[Name]	[Date]	Not started
User Manual	[Name]	[Date]	Not started
Admin Guide	[Name]	[Date]	Not started
Final Project Report	[Name]	[Date]	Not started

8. Tools Used

Purpose	Tool
Writing documents	Microsoft Word, Google Docs, Markdown
Diagrams	draw.io, Lucidchart, Figma
API documentation	Swagger / Postman
Storage and sharing	GitHub, Google Drive, Confluence
Version tracking	Git

9. Review and Approval Process

- Author writes the first draft.
- Peer or team lead reviews for accuracy and clarity.
- Corrections are made and the version number is updated.
- Project manager gives the final approval.
- Approved documents are stored and shared with stakeholders.

10. Risks

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Documentation left to the end	High	Write documents alongside development
Outdated documents	Medium	Update after every change and track versions
Unclear or incomplete content	Medium	Use templates and peer review
Documents lost or scattered	Medium	Keep everything in one shared repository

11. Deliverables

- Technical documentation and API guide
- User manual and admin guide
- Test reports
- Final project report
- Handover document

12. Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Documentation Lead			
Project Manager			
Client / Stakeholder			